

The background features a large, vibrant, multi-colored spiral or concentric circle pattern in shades of purple, magenta, red, and teal, centered on the right side. To the left, there are faint, dark gray geometric elements including circular arcs, dashed lines, and small arrows, some of which are labeled with numbers like 150, 160, 170, 180, 190, 200, 210, 220, 230, 240, 250, and 260, suggesting a technical or architectural drawing style.

CONCENTRIC CIRCLES: LGBTQ+ ADOLESCENTS AND CREATING SAFE SPACES

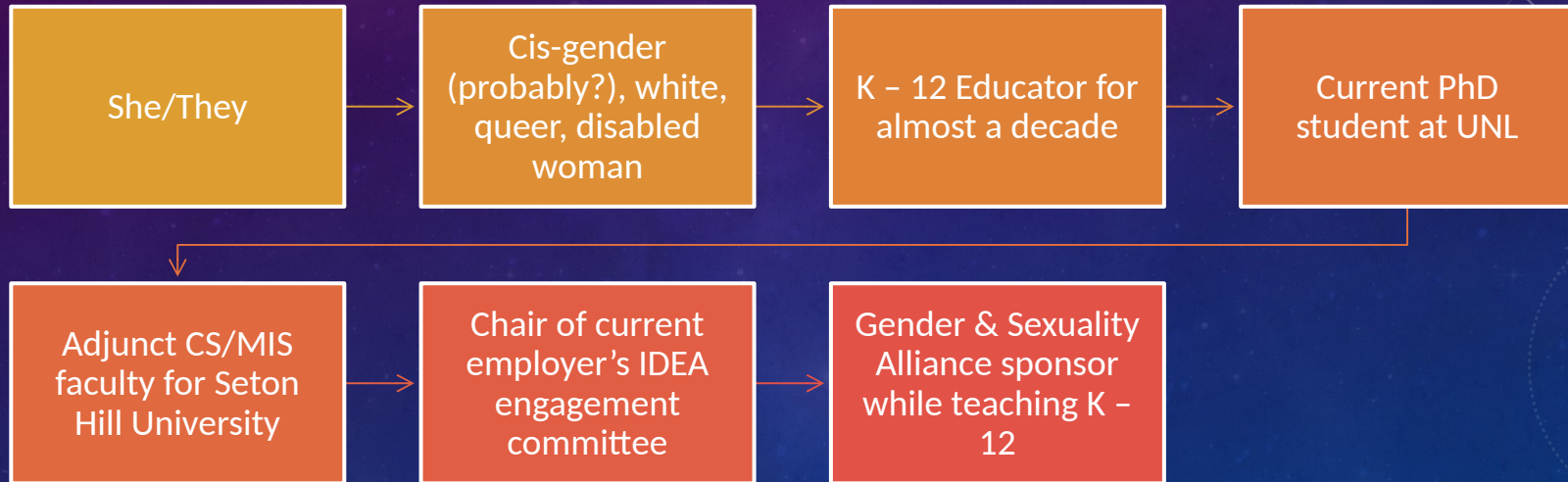
CONCENTRIC CIRCLES

This presentation discusses the variance in students' "coming out" experiences, what to do if you are chosen by students to share this information, and how to create spaces to foster inclusion by examining bias, levels of confidentiality, and the language surrounding personal identity and expression.

LGBTQ+ is an umbrella term and each person's story is individual and nuanced.

Educators should seek to address the individual needs of the student and create safe spaces for students of all backgrounds and experiences.

LET'S GET TO KNOW EACH OTHER



The background is a dark teal color. It features several horizontal rainbow flags (with stripes of red, orange, yellow, green, blue, and purple) that appear to be hanging from a pole. Overlaid on the flags and the background are faint, light-colored circular patterns. These include concentric circles, dashed lines, and arrows indicating a clockwise direction. Some of these circles have numerical labels: 140, 150, 160, 170, 180, 190, 200, 210, 220, 230, 240, 250, and 260. The overall aesthetic is modern and geometric.

LGBTQ YOUTH

POPULATION

- With regards to sexual orientation, the 2017 YRBS found that 10.5% of high school students identified as LGB: 2.5% identified as gay or lesbian and 8.0% as bisexual, (Kann et al., 2018).
- The YRBS also found that 5% of youth 13-18 identified as unsure of their sexual orientation.
- The Trevor Project: National Estimate of LGBTQ Youth Seriously Considering Suicide



SCHOOL SAFETY

- Almost half (46.1%) of LGBTQ+ youth report feeling unsafe in at least one school setting.
- Transgender and gender-expansive youth are more likely to report feeling unsafe in school than their LGBTQ+ peers:
- Over half (53.9%) of transgender and gender-expansive youth, versus 46% LGBTQ+ youth, feel unsafe in at least one school setting.

Transgender and gender-expansive youth were **more likely** to have told an adult than LGBTQ+ peers — but were **less likely** to report this adult helped them a lot (Figure 15).

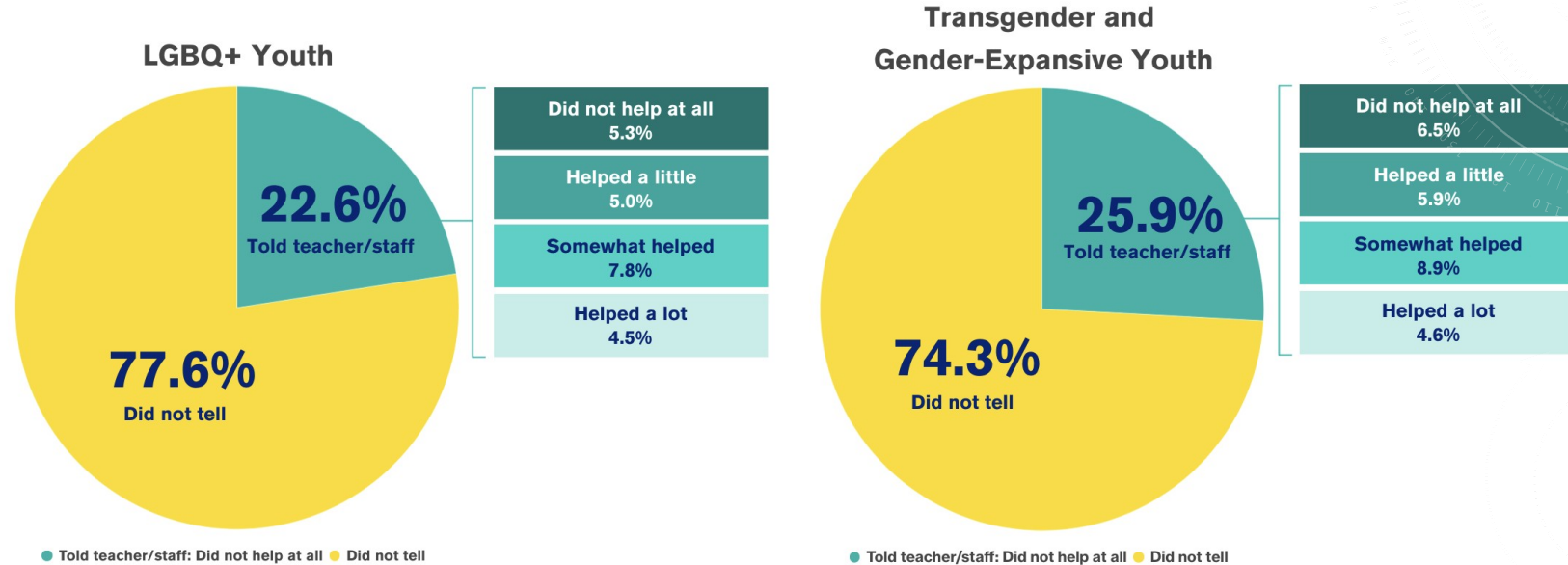
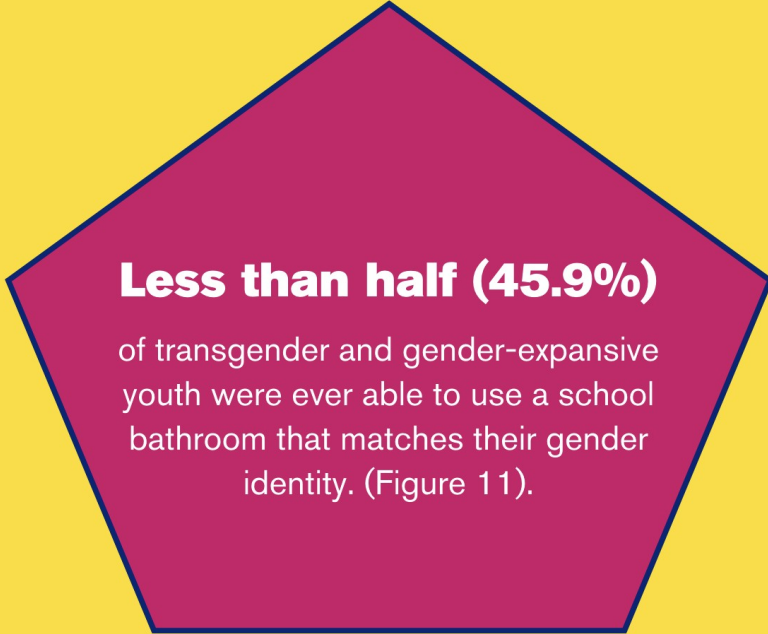


Figure 15: Disclosure of bullying, and impact of disclosure, among LGBTQ+ and Transgender and Gender-Expansive youth

LGBTQ+ REPRESENTATION IN SCHOOLS

For instance, over 8 in 10 LGBTQ+ youth in the Northeast and West are attending schools with a GSA, compared with 72% of LGBTQ+ youth in the Midwest, and less than two-thirds (63.5%) of youth in the South.

Over a quarter of LGBTQ+ youth in both the Northeast and West received LGBTQ+-inclusive sex education, compared with 16% of LGBTQ+ youth in the Midwest, and just 11.5% of LGBTQ+ youth in the South.



The infographic features a large magenta pentagon on the left and three overlapping rounded rectangular callouts on the right, all set against a yellow background. The pentagon contains the main statistic, while the callouts provide additional context and related findings.

Less than half (45.9%)

of transgender and gender-expansive youth were ever able to use a school bathroom that matches their gender identity. (Figure 11).

Less than **1 in 6 (15.6%)** report that others always use their correct pronoun

1 in 4 (25.1%) are able to always dress and express themselves in ways that match their gender identity

1 in 3 (37.9%) youth report that others “always” use their correct name

The background is a solid dark blue. It features several abstract geometric elements in a lighter blue color. On the left side, there are concentric circles and arcs, some of which are marked with degree values ranging from 140 to 260. There are also smaller circles and arcs scattered across the upper and lower portions of the image, some with arrows indicating a direction of movement or rotation. The overall aesthetic is technical and modern.

IN DIVERSE POPULATIONS
OF STUDENTS AND FACULTY,
HETERONORMATIVITY IS
CONSIDERED THE DEFAULT
OF THE PUBLIC SCHOOL
SETTING

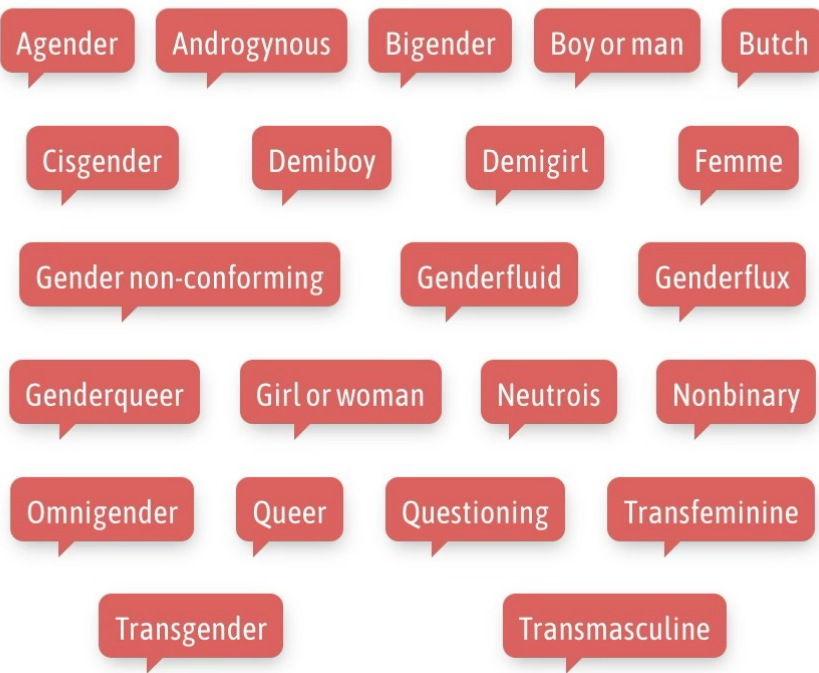
PRONOUNS USAGE AMONG LGBTQ YOUTH

Although 75% of youth use either he/him or she/her exclusively, 25% of LGBTQ youth use they/them exclusively, a combination of he/him, she/her, or they/them, or neopronouns such as ze/zir or fae/faer.

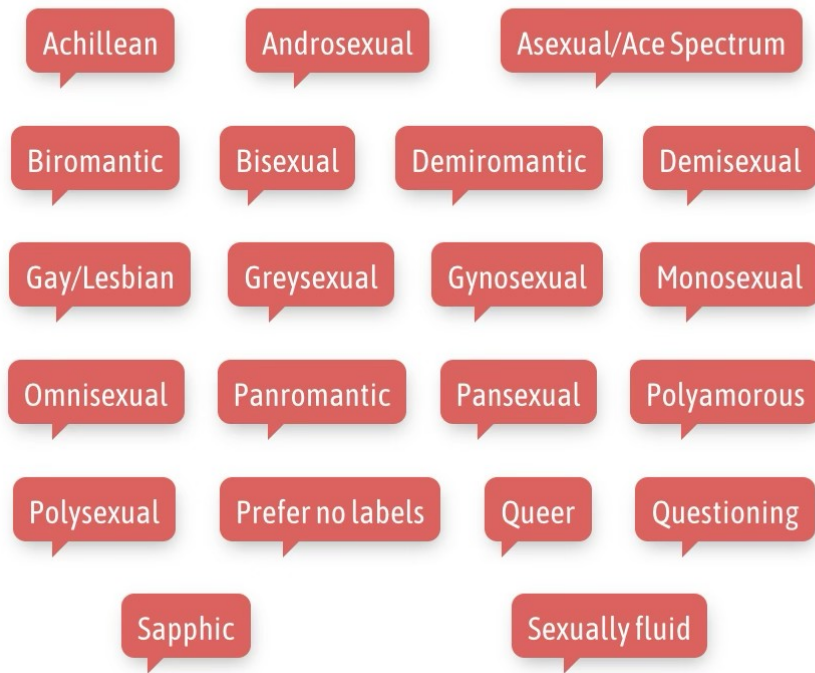


LGBTQ youth identify themselves in an incredibly wide range of ways.

LGBTQ youth in the survey identified with more than 100 different combinations of terms to describe their gender identity:



LGBTQ youth in the survey identified with more than 100 different combinations of terms to describe their sexual orientation:



STRATEGIES IN YOUR CLASSROOM

Where possible, post positive and LGBTQ+ affirming symbols, such as pride flags and safe space stickers, in your classroom and your school.

Where possible, provide age-appropriate books that teach about LGBTQ+ people, histories and identities.

Intentionally check-in on LGBTQ+ students about their experiences with harassment and violence in school and report incidents to administration.

Consistently use the correct name and pronoun for all students and provide this information to substitutes and other educators in your school.

STRATEGIES IN YOUR SCHOOL

Advocate	Advocate for LGBTQ+ inclusive practices in your school and professional development training on bias- based bullying for you and your fellow educators.
Ensure	Ensure your school has a process to address bias-based harassment and violence that explicitly protects LGBTQ+ students.
Create or support	Create or support a Gender & Sexuality Alliance (GSA) in your middle school and/or high school to provide support for LGBTQ+ students and allies.

STRATEGIES IN YOUR DISTRICT

Provide LGBTQ+ affirming local resources including affirming mental health resources to support LGBTQ+ students and families.

Where possible, advocate for trans-inclusive participation in school sports and physical education.

Where possible, advocate for LGBTQ+ inclusion at your local school board.



ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

- [The Trevor Project National Survey on LGBT Q Youth Mental Health 2020](#)
- [HRC Foundation 2023 LGBTQ+ Youth Report](#)